

CARVAKA (CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA)

SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY → EPISTEMIC GATE → INFERENCE CONTROVERSY → MATERIAL ONTOLOGY → TRANSCENDENT DENIALS → ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g14 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY

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RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE LOST BRĤASPATI-SŪTRA OPPONENT REPORTS QUOTED FRAGMENTS

(MĀDHAVA, JAYANTA, (OFTEN POLEMICAL)

DISTINGUISH ATTESTED THESIS FROM HOSTILE CARICATURE

THIS-WORLDLY ORIENTATION; CĀRVĀKA

MATERIALIST SCHOOL LABEL.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA: RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE lost Brĥaspati-sŭtra opponent reports quoted fragments
- (Mādhava, Jayanta, (often polemical)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- RULE: distinguish attested thesis from hostile caricature
- Lokāyata = this-worldly orientation; Cārvāka = materialist school label.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA: RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE lost Brĥaspati-sŭtra opponent reports quoted fragments
- (Mādhava, Jayanta, (often polemical)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka is recoverable only through source-critical reconstruction: hostile testimony must be qualified, but convergent reports still establish a stable materialist core.

01

STAGE 01

EPISTEMIC GATE

EPISTEMIC GATE

VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES

PERCEPTION (PRATYAKṢA)

PERCEPTION INFERENCE (ANUMĀNA) VERBAL TESTIMONY

(ŚABDA) COMPARISON (UPAMĀNA) DIRECT, SENSE-GROUNDED INFERENCE TESTIMONY COMPARISON OBSERVED

SMOKE IS INVARIABLY FIRE-LINKED.

VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES

PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa) / PERCEPTION inference (anumāna) verbal testimony

(śabda) comparison (upamāna) direct, sense-grounded inference testimony comparison observed conjunction is finite

universal invariable concomitance (vyāpti) outruns perception smoke seen with fire in kitchens != smoke is

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES
- PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa) / PERCEPTION inference (anumāna) verbal testimony

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- (śabda) comparison (upamāna) direct, sense-grounded inference testimony comparison observed conjunction is finite
- universal invariable concomitance (vyāpti) outruns perception smoke seen with fire in kitchens != smoke is invariably fire-linked.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES
- PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa) / PERCEPTION inference (anumāna) verbal testimony

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats perception (pratyakṣa) as the only independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

02

STAGE 02

INFERENCE CONTROVERSY

INFERENCE CONTROVERSY

CĀRVĀKA ATTACK

INFERENCE NEEDS UNIVERSAL CONCOMITANCE (VYĀPTI) INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (VYĀPTI) KNOWN

BY PERCEPTION

INCOMPLETE SURVEY HIDDEN CONDITION (UPĀDHI) MAY DEFEAT THE RULE

FIRE WITHOUT SMOKE, WET FUEL MATTERS

NYĀYA REPLY

REPEATED AGREEMENT + ABSENCE OF COUNTER-INSTANCE + HYPOTHETICAL REASONING

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- CĀRVĀKA ATTACK: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti) invariable concomitance (vyāpti) known by inference → circularity
- by perception → incomplete survey hidden condition (upādhi) may defeat the rule: fire without smoke, wet fuel matters

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- NYĀYA REPLY: repeated agreement + absence of counter-instance + hypothetical reasoning (tarka) agreement in presence (anvaya) (presence) +
- agreement in absence (vyatireka) (absence) → defeasible but rational invariable concomitance (vyāpti)

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- CĀRVĀKA COUNTER-PRESSURE: practical expectation may work without certainty
- SELF-REFUTATION CHARGE: arguing against inference already employs inference.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka attacks inference by arguing that finite observation cannot establish universal concomitance and may always conceal a defeating condition.

03

STAGE 03

MATERIAL ONTOLOGY

MATERIAL ONTOLOGY

ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED EARTH + WATER +

ORGANISED LIVING BODY

CONSCIOUSNESS CONSCIOUSNESS IS A BODY-PROPERTY, NOT AN IMMATERIAL SUBSTANCE

FERMENTATION INGREDIENTS

INTOXICATING POWER NOT PRESENT SEPARATELY

LIVING CONSCIOUS BODY (DEHĀTMA-VĀDA) DEATH

ELEMENTAL DISSOLUTION

ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living

03

STAGE 03 MATERIAL ONTOLOGY

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- ORGANISED LIVING BODY
- CONSCIOUSNESS CONSCIOUSNESS IS A BODY-PROPERTY, NOT AN IMMATERIAL SUBSTANCE
- FERMENTATION INGREDIENTS
- INTOXICATING POWER NOT PRESENT SEPARATELY
- LIVING CONSCIOUS BODY (DEHĀTMA-VĀDA) DEATH
- ELEMENTAL DISSOLUTION

ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living

consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not

SELF = living conscious body (dehātma-vāda) death → elemental dissolution → no surviving enduring self

QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living body → consciousness

consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not present separately

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

SELF = living conscious body (dehātma-vāda) death → elemental dissolution → no surviving enduring self (ātman), rebirth or afterlife

QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living body → consciousness

consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not present separately

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka explains consciousness as an emergent property of organised matter, though it offers an analogy of emergence rather than a developed causal mechanism.

04

STAGE 04 TRANSCENDENT DENIALS

- TRANSCENDENT DENIALS
- NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT
- NO IMMORTAL SOUL
- NO REBIRTH
- NO ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (KARMA) AS SUPERSENSIBLE MORAL
- NO HEAVEN/HELL
- NO POST-MORTEM REWARD OR PUNISHMENT
- NO CREATOR GOD

NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT

no immortal soul → no rebirth

no action and moral consequence (karma) as supersensible moral force

no heaven/hell → no post-mortem reward or punishment

no creator God → world needs no transcendent planner

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT

no immortal soul → no rebirth

no action and moral consequence (karma) as supersensible moral force

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

no heaven/hell → no post-mortem reward or punishment

no creator God → world needs no transcendent planner

no Vedic infallibility → priestly testimony lacks intrinsic authority

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

RESULT: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Once perception is the sole independent warrant, soul, creator, rebirth and unseen ritual efficacy lose their claimed epistemic foundation.

05

STAGE 05 ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE

- ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE
- PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER DHARMA
- REJECTED WHEN GROUNDED IN UNSEEN REWARD OR VEDIC COMMAND
- REJECTED AS LIBERATION OF A SEPARABLE SOUL MATERIAL WELL-BEING
- INTELLIGIBLE GOODS WITHIN ONE EMBODIED LIFE PRUDENT ENJOYMENT
- RECKLESS INDULGENCE PLEASURE SOUGHT
- WEIGH PAIN, SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE AND ATTAINABLE MEANS
- EXAM CONTROL

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command liberation (mokṣa): rejected as liberation of	reckless indulgence pleasure sought → weigh pain, social consequence and attainable means	do not reduce the school to the hostile slogan "eat, drink and borrow."
a separable soul material well-being (artha) + pleasure (kāma): intelligible goods within one embodied life prudent enjoyment !=	EXAM CONTROL: call it naturalistic hedonism or this-worldliness	PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command liberation (mokṣa): rejected as liberation of

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

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DECISIVE DISTINCTION

reckless indulgence pleasure sought → weigh pain, social consequence and attainable means

EXAM CONTROL: call it naturalistic hedonism or this-worldliness

EVALUATION / TRAP

do not reduce the school to the hostile slogan "eat, drink and borrow."

PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command liberation (mokṣa): rejected as liberation of

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

06

STAGE 06 COMPARATIVE PRESSURE MAP

